

Clermont County Township Association Regular Meeting Minutes

Date: 02/19/2026

Host: Pierce Township

Call to Order: At 6:25 PM Allen Freeman called for everyone's attention. The following CCTA Officers & Active Members were in attendance:

Batavia Township:

Trustee Danielle Wessell

Fiscal Officer Jennifer Haley

Goshen Township:

Trustee / CCTA Vice-President Bob Hausermann

Miami Township:

Trustee Mary Makley Wolff

Monroe Township:

Trustee Tom Peck

Trustee Lindsey Aranyos

Trustee Arthea Morgan

Ohio Township:

Trustee Keith Vogelsang

Trustee Scott Wolf

Pierce Township:

Trustee / CCTA President Allen Freeman

Trustee Joe Sheppard

Fiscal Officer Debbie Schwey

Tate Township:

Trustee Christen Steimle

Fiscal Officer Kathy Brannock

Union Township:

Trustee John Becker

Washington Township:

Trustee Dennis Cooper

Williamsburg Township:

Trustee Gary Jordan

Trustee Charlie Maklem

And CCTA Secretary/Treasurer Shelby Baird

Mr. Freeman called for everyone's attention and made a few brief announcements. Mr. Freeman offered thanks to Debbie Schwey for putting things together in the meeting room and for making food available. He then announced that Rep. Schmidt was running a little late, so we'll move on to dinner to give her a little more time. Mr. Freeman then introduced Pierce Township's new Trustee Dr. Joe Sheppard. At approximately 6:28 PM, Mr. Freeman invited everyone to grab some food.

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CCTA Business:

At approximately 6:45 PM Mr. Freeman again called the meeting to order. Mr. Hausermann led the Pledge of Allegiance, and a prayer was offered by County Commissioner David Painter.

Mr. Freeman stated we would dispense with the CCTA business quickly. He asked Mr. Baird to present the Treasurer's report. Mr. Baird shared that the available cash on hand for the month of January, 2026 remained level at \$3,068.49 with no pending or cleared deposits or withdrawals. Mr. Freeman called for a motion to approve the Treasurer's report. Mr. Hausermann moved to approve the report as read, seconded by Mr. Vogelsang. Motion carried without opposition.

Mr. Freeman asked if everyone had a chance to review the minutes of the January 19, 2026 meeting and asked if there were any omissions or corrections needed. There being none, Mr. Freeman called for a motion to approve the minutes. Mr. Peck moved to approve the minutes, seconded by Mr. Maklem. Motion carried without opposition, with Mr. Cooper voting present as he was not in attendance at the January 19, 2026 meeting.

Mr. Freeman proceeded to provide a brief review of issues discussed at the last meeting about the CCTA's legislative agenda to work with the legislature on ways to open other opportunities for increasing local revenue, and that we are also continuing to focus on increasing the distribution percentage on the State and Local Government fund.

General Discussion:

Mr. Freeman then gave the floor to Rep. Jean Schmidt, Ohio District 62. Following Rep. Schmidt's conclusion on her summary of recent activities at the legislature, specifically on committee issues, and some brief Q&A and discussions with members, Rep. Schmidt turned the floor over to Rep. Adam Byrd, Ohio District 63. Mr. Bird continued with his own summary of important bills and issues working through the legislature that he feels are particularly important for the CCTA members to be aware of.

Mr. Freeman took the floor at the conclusion of Rep. Bird's discussion and returned to the topic of the legislative agenda by continuing discussion on the annexation issue brought up by Rep. Bird. An open discussion followed with some status updates from Rep. Bird on the petition for abolishing property taxes. Rep. Bird stressed the importance of these issues, echoed by Rep. Schmidt. Roundtable Q&A and discussions continued on the topics of property tax abolition, income tax elimination, and the practical realities of how townships' services would be affected, and on ideas about methods for replacement of those revenues by new means.

Mr. Freeman returned to discussion of the CCTA Legislative Agenda and advocated for having CCTA members go to Columbus to testify before Ohio House Committees. Mr. Freeman acknowledged that there were also members of the Fire Chiefs' Association present and asked them to introduce themselves. Fire Chief Craig Wright from Pierce Township, Fire Chief Roy Short from Batavia CJFD, and Fire Chief Chris Cooper from Bethel Tate Fire Department introduced themselves. Mr. Freeman had invited them to the discussion tonight due to the importance of the property tax issue and revenue concerns that will directly impact Township emergency services.

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Discussion continued with the topic of property taxes and revenue, and the perceived disconnect between townships and the State. Mr. Freeman returned to the Fire Chief's and turned the floor over to them to summarize their discussions and efforts. The Fire Chiefs touched on the topics of property taxes, grants and eligibility requirements, the effect valuations have on the issue, and concerns for how these revenue issues are going to be resolved. The generalized discussions continued along the same points and concerns.

Mr. Freeman brought the discussion to a close and moved on to the remaining items to be discussed.

Sub-Committee Activity:

Mr. Freeman stated that we will skip over the sub-committee information this evening.

Mr. Freeman acknowledged Dennis Cooper as he had some information he wanted to share. Mr. Cooper reminded those present that the Clermont County Board of Health District Advisory Council meeting is March 19. Mr. Cooper shared details about the info packet that was sent to townships and stressed that it is a very important meeting due to needing to fill the position of physician on the Board. He shared the qualification requirements for the position, and protocol for how the candidates need to be nominated. Mr. Cooper invited members to put forth any qualified candidates they may know that would be interested in serving on the Board. The DAC meeting starts at 7:15 PM.

Rep. Schmidt thanked the CCTA for having as a guest this evening and excused herself as she had some pressing phone calls she needed to return.

Mr. Freeman asked if any other townships had anything they'd like to share or discuss. There being none, Mr. Freeman called for a motion to adjourn. Mr. Hausermann moved to adjourn, seconded by Mr. Cooper. Meeting adjourned at 8:20 PM.